Product Modes: Client Feedback Brief

Sprint 0 · Android · Prepared for the PM · 28 Sep 2026

1. What the client is asking for

The client wants **one product that runs in two modes**. Our current UI designs cover only the first.

- **Parent-controlled (remote)**, the current design direction: the parent monitors, manages and acts on the child's device from their own phone. Mainly for **ages 3–10**.
- **Independent / local**: the app runs on one phone with no ongoing parental monitoring. It's used by an **older child (11–17)** who keeps the protections they grew up with (safe browsing, ad blocking, image and video blur), or by a **parent or adult** as a personal safe-browsing tool.

> **Guiding principle: "protection without constant monitoring."** Protection must not feel like control or surveillance. If the phone feels restricted, the child loses trust and moves to another device, and the protection is gone. The app should protect quietly in the background without changing how the device is normally used.

What they need now: not a build in Sprint 0. They need assurance that the design and architecture **don't lock us into remote parental control only**. They also asked for two lightweight additions: **Invite a friend / recommend Aman** and **Contact us on WhatsApp**, neither of which should feel commercial.

2. Where the Android build stands today

- **It is already local-first.** There's no backend, no device pairing and no remote channel. Every protection runs on the device itself. Independent mode is therefore close to what exists today, and remote control is the layer still to be added.
- **Protections don't depend on the mode.** VPN, DNS filtering, blur and private-tab handling don't care who configured them.
- **What's built around a parent is the surface:** onboarding asks for the child's name and age, the dashboard shows the child's name, and the wording on screen and in alerts is addressed to a parent.
- **Gap:** there's no parent PIN or lock on the device, so the child could change the settings. Parent-controlled mode needs one whether or not remote control is added.

> **The main risk is not the engine.** It's building the Phase 1 backend and the UI as though remote parental control were the only model.

3. How the two modes differ

	Parent-controlled	Independent / local
Who configures	Parent, remotely or behind a PIN	The user, on the device
Who sees activity	Parent, synced off the device	Only the user, or nobody (counts only)
Alerts	Pushed to the parent's phone	None, or a gentle notice to the user
Protection switched off	Parent is alerted	User is prompted to turn it back on
Wording on screen	"Blocked by your parent's settings"	"Blurred to keep browsing safe"
Enforcement	Strict (device admin, locked settings)	Light; the user stays in control
Main protections	All ten	Browsing, ads, blur, search filtering
Needs a backend	Yes (pairing, sync, push)	No; works as the app does today

4. Recommended plan

Sprint 0 (now): decisions and documentation, minimal code

- State in the Sprint 0 report that the protection engine is already local-first. This directly answers the client's concern.

- Record the architecture decision: one top-level **product mode** setting decides who configures, where activity goes and how the app speaks. It sits above the protections, not inside them.
- Define remote parental control as an **optional add-on**. Independent mode must work fully without it.

Design (for the design team)

- Onboarding opens with *"Who is this phone for?"*: my child, myself, or a teen managing their own protection.
- A softer home screen for independent mode in the chosen dark direction, showing "what's protecting you" rather than "what your child did".
- Neutral, non-accusing wording on everything the child sees.

Phase 1 (Android, once approved)

1. Product mode setting and the onboarding choice.
2. Mode-aware wording on block screens, notices and alerts.
3. Activity log visibility per mode. Content is never stored, so local-only logging is already privacy-friendly.
4. Parent PIN or lock for parent-controlled mode on the child's device.
5. Remote module (pairing, activity sync, remote actions), parent-controlled mode only. This is the largest new piece: backend plus parent app.
6. Later: a "graduation" path from parent-controlled to independent as the child grows.
7. Invite a friend: the Android share sheet with a Play Store link (about 1 day).
8. Contact us on WhatsApp: opens a chat with the support number (a few hours).

5. Questions to confirm with the client

1. In independent mode, can the user switch protections off? Letting them is less controlling but also weaker protection. Where is the line?
2. Moving from parent-controlled to independent: who triggers it (the parent, or an age threshold), and does the parent keep any visibility, such as a weekly summary without details?
3. Is remote parental control in Phase 1 scope? It adds a backend and a parent app, including iOS.
4. WhatsApp: which number, and is it for support only or also sales?